

Turn your TV into a Linux all-purpose PC!



We all have heard about Android TV sticks, using which you can turn your regular TV into a smart TV, which can then run thousands of Android apps. Now, those interested in Linux can run Ubuntu on sticks like Rockchip RK3066 dual-core processors, which can be bought for around \$42.

There is also a customised version of Ubuntu called Picuntu that has been in the works for quite some time. The solution basically offers you a basic desktop Linux environment, which can be used on devices like the UG802 or MK808 mini PC. However, if you want something more advanced and feature-packed, then try Picuntu home://io.

The Picuntu home://io edition is based on Picuntu RC3. It comes with initial support for hardware accelerated graphics using the RK3066 processor's Mali 400 graphics. However, the biggest differentiator between this edition and a regular Picuntu installation is that it comes with some extra goodies. The developer, JustinTime4Tea, has reportedly added a number of apps that let you quickly start using a TV box as a Linux-powered game console, Web server, or all-purpose PC, reports Lilliputing, a website focused on news from the mobile computing space.

stable versions of all popular desktop environments such as KDE, GNOME and Cinnamon, and it includes a wide range of software catering to the needs of everyone, a selection from the openSUSE Education repository, multimedia



from the Packman repository, development tools, KIWI-LTSP (which allows normal PC or diskless thin clients to network boot from a server running Li-f-e), and a lot more. In a nutshell, everything you need to make your computer useful is available right out-of-the-box as soon as Li-f-e is installed on it.

As this edition is based on openSUSE 12.3, all the official 12.3 updates, repositories from the build service and Packman can be used to install additional software and keep it up to date.

The minimum hardware requirement is 1 GB of RAM and 15 GB of free disk space. Installation from a USB stick will take about 40 minutes to complete, while from a DVD it takes much longer.

Now Google dumps custom Linux in favour of Debian

Debian is surely going places! First it took over NASA's PCs in space and now Google has decided to ditch its custom version of Linux for Debian! The search giant will be moving the default software for its rentable cloud servers to Debian.

The company announced the decision of making Debian the default image type for its Compute Engine recently. So now, Linux OS GCCEL (Google Compute Engine Linux) will be replaced by Debian 6.0 and 7.0.

Commenting on the move, Jimmy Kaplowitz, Google site reliability engineer, wrote, "We are continually evaluating other operating systems that we can enable with Compute Engine. However, going forward, Debian will be the default image type for Compute Engine."

Google has asked all developers to switch to Debian images instead of GCCEL, which as per Google FAQs is "a Linux distribution using Debian packages found in typical minimal Ubuntu distributions."

Both the versions of Debian, Debian 6.0 'Squeeze' and 7.0 'Wheezy' have some differences, besides the process of having module loading and direct memory access disabled for security purposes.

PayPal introduces Android SDK for developers



Though this news holds great significance for developers, online shoppers who use PayPal for payments may find it equally useful. The online payment processor, PayPal, has introduced the Android SDK for US-based developers starting from May 15, 2013.

While the company launched the iOS SDK just two months back in March, the Android version is being seen as an important move to cater to the growing needs of smartphone users. The Android SDK will support Android 2.2 and higher versions.